

The sun

At the center of the solar system is a star we call the sun. It is a vast ball of hot, glowing gases that are held together by a force called **gravity**. The sun is made up of many layers. It has been shining for nearly 5 billion years.

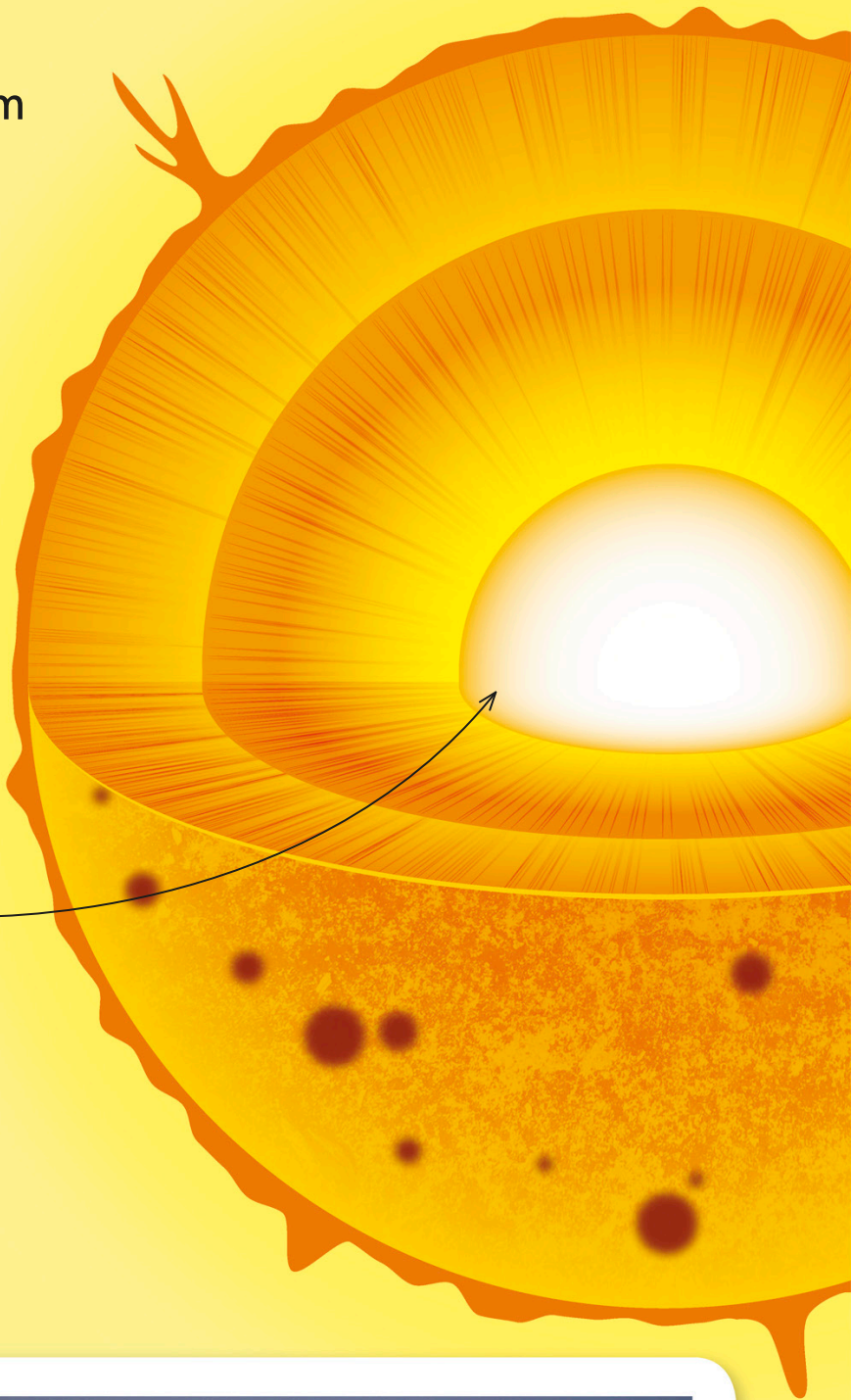


Core

At the heart of the sun is the core, which produces the sun's energy. It's a bit like a giant furnace, with hydrogen gas as the fuel that keeps it burning.

How hot?

The sun's surface is extremely hot, about 9,600°F (5,300°C). In its core, however, temperatures soar to a mind-boggling 29 million°F (16 million°C).



Moving sun

The sun appears to travel across the sky each day, but it's really the Earth that is moving. Earth spins on its axis, but we don't notice this movement. So it seems to us as though the sun is moving instead.

